

Competency Matrix

Define 4–6 competencies per role before writing a single interview question. Fewer, measured well, beats many measured loosely.

How to use this matrix

- 1. List the capabilities that separate strong performers from weak ones in THIS role — not generic virtues.
- 2. For each, write an observable definition: what does demonstrating it look like?
- 3. Map each competency to 2 interview questions (see the Question Bank).
- 4. Weight competencies if they are not equally important — and decide weights before interviewing.

Role competency matrix

Role: _____ Level: _____

Competency	Observable definition (what demonstrating it looks like)	Weight	Q1 / Q2

Example — Senior Customer Success Manager

Competency	Observable definition	Weight
Commercial judgment	Can walk through a renewal they saved or expanded, with the specific levers they used and why.	30%
Difficult conversations	Can describe delivering unwelcome news to a customer directly, with preparation and follow-up.	25%
Prioritization	Can explain how they triaged a book of 40+ accounts, including what they deliberately dropped.	25%
Cross-team influence	Can give an example of getting product/engineering to act on a customer need without authority.	20%

Quality checks

- Every competency is observable in an interview. ('Passion' and 'hunger' are not — cut them.)
- A current strong performer would score 4+ on every row. If not, the definitions are wrong.

- No more than 6 rows. Interviewer fatigue makes later scores soft.

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